Universal token system · Phase 5

One word, one meaning.

The ordered color ramp stops borrowing the name of the type multiplier — `--scale-*` becomes `--seq-*`.

"scale" meant two unrelated things.

The collision

`--scale-500` was an ordered color ramp; `--fs-scale` was the type-size multiplier. Same word, unrelated jobs.

seq

The sequential ramp is now `--seq-50` … `--seq-900` — ordered/quantitative encoding (heat, intensity).

fs-scale

Untouched, and now unambiguous: the only "scale" left is the typographic one.

Read it right

`--seq-700` is a ramp stop; it can never be mistaken for a font size again.

The seq ramp in use — frequency as heat.

velocity talent

execution

risk

cadence discipline

SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

A

A

a

less

Sequential is for ordered data.

Not categorical

The `--seq-*` ramp encodes magnitude — heat, progress intensity, faint grid. The unordered groups stay on the categorical `--cat-*` cycle from phase 1.

Phase 5 of 7 · see engineering/decisions/2026-06-11-universal-token-system.md

No more two-meaning "scale".